

Please write short answers to the following questions.

Question 1

Tell us about a specific time when you mentored a junior engineer (or a peer) who was struggling with the quality or maintainability of their test code.

- How did you identify the issue?
- What specific techniques or tools did you introduce to help them level up?
- Looking back today, what would you have handled differently in your mentoring approach to make it more effective?

Answer

One recent example I have is of one of my colleagues who was struggling to implement the proper test cases in Selenium/Java/TestNg. More specifically, the tests that they were writing were very flaky and did not test the correct functionality.

I Identified the issue in the Peer Review phase. I immediately recognized the problems and the when executed locally my colleagues code, I had the proof that a few major fixes were needed.

The techniques/tools I used was mainly to perform a peer-programming/peer-testing session. This is where we sat together and step by step compared the current solution (which was not acceptable according to our standards) with a correct fully-functional solution. This was not a theoretical discussion but a hands-on meeting with applied and specific code examples.

For this particular example, I think I handled it very well. My colleague was very happy with what we did together and the overall work was of high quality. As a more generic approach, what I want (and I am constantly trying to improve) in my mentoring is for me to be 100% sure that what I am proposing is actually helpful and not just my opinion. In some cases my personal preferences (or ego) gets in the way. This I handle by constantly challenging the tools and techniques I know by reading and updating my methodologies. And of course by discussing with my colleagues their needs and problems and trying to find the best way to solve them collaboratively.

Question 2

Describe a real-life situation where you had limited time for coaching and code reviews while managing a team with mixed experience levels.

- How did you decide where to invest your time to ensure the whole team improved without compromising delivery?
- What specific criteria did you use to prioritize your efforts, and why?
- Looking back today, what is one thing you would have handled differently to better balance team growth with project deadlines?

In my current position, a few months ago, we had to implement a new payment system, which I was

the lead tester. We had a very strict deadline which we had to adhere due to government regulations. Although we had ample time to test all critical and major features, when the deadline came close we hadn't finalized all automation and regression suites (which we needed for further testing and implementation of new payment features).

This means that we had to organize ourselves within the QA team to share responsibilities according to the strengths of the team. More senior testers took the more demanding aspects of our automation testing while more junior testers took the more easy parts. This means that the prioritization was a mix of seniority and difficulty of the task. We monitored this daily in order to reconfigure who does what, remove roadblocks and help anyone that needs assistance. This not only helped the team to move efficiently under pressure, but we also delivered a 100% perfect release with no flaws. Not to minimize also the importance that we helped junior testers not get stressed and overwhelmed and just be ok to explore and fail.

One thing I would have done differently is maybe better organize the delivery of our automation suites within the team from the beginning of our QA efforts. This way senior testers would not have to take most of the load while also junior testers could take more responsibilities (without compromises in the quality of the work)